



Equity & Excellence
Access in Higher Education

July 9-13, 2019
Boston, Massachusetts

Welcome to Faculty Perspectives on Inclusive Courses: Teaching College Students with Intellectual Disability

*Please be respectful of your colleagues by silencing your phone.
If you need to answer a call, please go to the hallway.*



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We ask you to join us in creating a culture of

- **Access**
- **Inclusion**
- **Civility, and**
- **Respect**

...this week and in all aspects of our organization.





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Overview

- Qualitative study of faculty experiences teaching inclusive courses
 - “Inclusive” = students with and without Intellectual Disability (ID)
- At Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSID)
- For TPSID National Coordinating Center (NCC)

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Recruitment & Sample



≥ 3 students
w/ID



10 Faculty

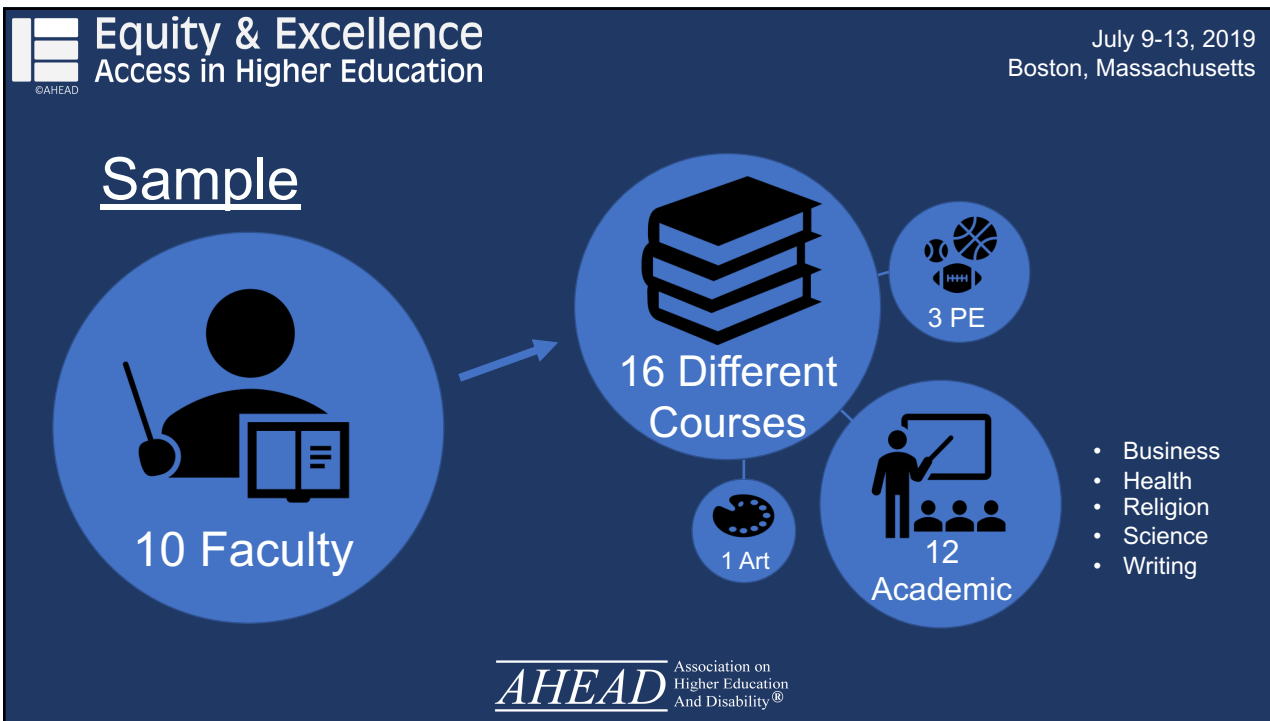


7 IHEs



Avg 13 years
teaching

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Data Collection and Analysis

- Data Collection: Flexible qualitative interviews using interview guide, recorded and transcribed
- Data Analysis: Used Atlas.ti for thematic coding and memoing
- Collaborative process

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Results

- **Enrollment:** What issues influence college and university faculty to collaborate with higher education programs for students with ID?
- **Instruction:** What are the benefits and challenges of teaching college courses that include students with ID, and do they differ from other instructional experiences?
- **Impact:** Have these instructional experiences changed faculty views about disability, instruction, or inclusion?



Enrollment

- **Enrollment:** What influences faculty to collaborate with higher education programs for students with ID?
 - For the most part, faculty did not feel as if they were given a meaningful choice whether to accept a student into their class or not.
 - Some were nervous at first but eventually embraced the experience.
 - Most were happy to participate.

When I was asked if I would allow a student in, I thought that it was really very nice that they would even consider having a student in my class for this program. I didn't know anything about it. But...I was really pleased that they had asked me.



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Instruction

- **Instruction:** What are the benefits and challenges of teaching inclusive college courses?

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Benefits: Improves Learning

- TPSID students bring up “really thoughtful questions” that typical students “just wouldn't think to ask,” whereas many typical students are “reluctant to ask questions” even if they don't understand.

And we've had sometimes where [TPSID] students will bring up something or ask a question that really sparks a good discussion, which leads to the benefit to the traditional students.

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Challenges: Classroom Management

Sometimes the flow of the classroom is disrupted by a student who may not have the social awareness that most students do. And by that, I mean they might blurt something out in response to something that I'm lecturing on, or they might continue to raise their hand.

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Benefits: Improves Teaching

- Instructors learn to break down concepts to make the material more universally accessible:

With the [TPSID] students, it's: "Okay, how do I make this where a lay person can understand it?"...In doing that, it really has caused me to stop and think, man, a lot of times I've just made this material a lot more difficult than it needs to be. So, I think it's helped me make sure that the material that I'm covering in these classes is accessible to a wider audience than just a half a dozen people in my field.

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Challenges: Teaching

If that student is going to spend three months in my class...I would like them to have the most benefit.

Some of the challenges are just trying to then, outside the classroom, follow up with the [TPSID] students to translate some of the more complicated concepts that might have been lectured on into something they can grasp. So breaking it down like another level for them.

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Benefits: Improves Class Environment

- Many faculty said that TPSID students often bring a greater level of “enthusiasm” and a “positive attitude” into the classroom that’s “contagious” and improves the environment for everyone.

So my daytime classes are inclusive, and then in the evenings, they’re not. So it’s very obvious that the classes that are inclusive are...more dynamic, more engaged.

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Challenges: Need for information/preparation

- ID and disabilities in general
- The TPSID's goals, procedures, and expectations
- Students' disabilities, capabilities, goals, interests, and needs (incl. accommodations)
- Teaching approaches
 - Classroom techniques
 - Modifying syllabi
 - Assessments

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Impact: Learning Value of Inclusion

- Faculty reported that observing the capabilities of students w/ID gave them a broader and stronger sense of inclusion, and made them better at applying principles of inclusion.

[Students with ID] helped me with my teaching, in just reminding me that they're able to participate, do the same things that any student is able to.

It's allowed me to really impact a wider diverse population... I was nervous. But it really gave myself confidence that I can work with any type of student.

It's one thing to talk about inclusion; it's another thing to be able to see it in practice.

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Recommendations: Recruitment

- Match students carefully with courses
- Contact faculty early
- Enlist experienced faculty as ambassadors
- Communicate what support is available

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Recommendations: Orientation

- “Intellectual Disability 101”
- Program Overview
- Expectations
- Teaching practices
- Information about students

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Recommendations: Support

- Check in
- Share resources, teaching tips, etc.
- Facilitate communication among faculty
- Avoid relying entirely on peer mentors

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Conclusion

- Faculty were willing, sometimes eager, to teach students with ID but want more information and preparation.
- Faculty faced some challenges but saw benefits for everyone in inclusive courses.
- Faculty want to know more about their students so they can best meet their interests and needs.
- Programs tended to be “hands-off” with faculty, but faculty generally want more communication, support, and guidance.

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Session Evaluation

Please see session moderator for paper evaluation form or complete the evaluation online.

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